

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.8: The Present Active System

Classify conjugations and produce and parse present, imperfect, and future active forms, infinitives, and imperatives

Stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisite	EL-I.7 mastery: parse <i>sum/possum</i> and distinguish predicate and infinitive complements
Next	EL-I.9, The Perfect Active System

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 8: The Present Active System

On completing this unit, you can:

- use principal parts to identify a conjugation and present stem;
- form the present, imperfect, and future active indicative;
- recognize present active infinitives and imperatives; and
- parse finite active verbs in the Ordinary of the Mass and Vulgate.

1.1 Conjugations and present endings

A **conjugation** is a verb's regular pattern of inflection. A full verb entry begins with **principal parts**, the dictionary forms from which its major stems and systems are recovered, for example *laudo*, *laudare*, *laudavi*, *laudatum*. The second principal part identifies the conjugation: *-are*, first; *-ere* with long stem vowel in a marked dictionary, second; short-vowel *-ere*, third; and *-ire*, fourth. Third-conjugation *-io* verbs, such as *capio*, *capere*, *cepi*, *captum*, share features of the third and fourth. The present active personal endings are *-o/-m*, *-s*, *-t*, *-mus*, *-tis*, *-nt*.

The **present stem** is the base used to build the present, imperfect, and future systems. An **infinitive** is a non-finite verbal form: it has tense and voice but no grammatical person, and can complete another verb or perform a noun-like job. An **imperative** directly gives a command. A **finite** verb, by contrast, carries person and number and can anchor its own clause.

	1st <i>laudo</i>	2nd <i>moneo</i>	3rd <i>rego</i>	3rd- <i>io capio</i>	4th <i>audio</i>
1 sg.	laudo	moneo	rego	capio	audio
2 sg.	laudas	mones	regis	capis	audis
3 sg.	laudat	monet	regit	capit	audit
1 pl.	laudamus	monemus	regimus	capimus	audimus
2 pl.	laudatis	monetis	regitis	capitis	auditis
3 pl.	laudent	monent	regunt	capiunt	audiunt

1.2 Imperfect and future

The imperfect denotes continuing, repeated, or incomplete past action. Its forms are *laudabam*, *monebam*, *regebam*, *capiebam*, and *audiebam*, followed through *-bas*, *-bat*, *-bamus*, *-batis*, *-bant*. First- and second-conjugation futures use *-bo*, *-bis*, *-bit*, *-bimus*, *-bitis*, *-bunt*: *laudabo* and *monebo*. Third, third-*io*, and fourth use *-am*, *-es*, *-et*, *-emus*, *-etis*, *-ent*: *regam*, *reges*; *capiam*, *capies*; *audiam*, *audies*.

Present active infinitives are *laudare*, *monere*, *regere*, *capere*, *audire*. Singular present imperatives remove *-re*: *lauda*, *mone*, *rege*, *cape*, *audi*. Plural imperatives use the present stem plus *-te*; third and third-*io* insert *-i*: *laudate*, *monete*, *regite*, *capite*, *audite*. Common irregular imperatives should be learned when encountered.

Worked example: *Laudamus te. Benedicimus te. Adoramus te. Glorificamus te.*

Worked passage ID: W.I.30; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Every verb is first-person plural present active indicative, ending in *-mus*; *te* is the singular object each time. Translation: “We praise you. We bless you. We adore you. We glorify you.”

Worked example: *Credo in unum Deum*

Worked passage ID: W.I.31; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

credo is first-person singular present active indicative of *credo*, *credere*. Here *in* with the accusative expresses the one toward whom belief is directed. Translation: “I believe in one God.”

Worked example: *Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis*

Worked passage ID: W.I.32; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

tollis is second-person singular present active indicative because relative *qui* addresses the Lamb; *peccata* is its neuter plural object. *miserere* is a deponent imperative, previewed here rather than forced into the active pattern. Translation: “Lamb of God, who take away the sins of the world, have mercy on us.”

Worked example: *Petite, et accipietis* (Jn 16:24)

Worked passage ID: W.I.33; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

petite is second-person plural present active imperative. *accipietis* is second-person plural future active indicative of the third-*io* verb *accipio*: “Ask, and you will receive.”

Worked example: *Ego veniam et curabo eum* (Mt 8:7)

Worked passage ID: W.I.34; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

veniam is first-person singular future active of fourth-conjugation *venio*; *curabo* is the corresponding first-conjugation future. *eum* is the object of *curabo*. Translation: “I will come and heal him.”

1.3 Handwritten study and controlled composition

Copy the present table, boxing the changing stem vowels. Write complete imperfect and future paradigms for *laudo*, *rego*, and *audio*. For twelve forms, separate present stem, tense sign, and personal ending with vertical strokes. Transform *laudamus Deum* into imperfect and future; then into second-person singular and plural imperatives. Compose “the Lord guards the souls”, *Dominus animas custodit*; “we shall hear the word”, *Verbum audiemus*; and “praise the Lord!” to one and to many, *lauda Dominum! laudate Dominum!*

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Conjugations and present endings — transfer practice

Connection. A third--*io*/fourth contrast card prevents similar present forms from erasing different dictionary identities.

Transfer task. From the lesson entries for *capio* and *audio*, write infinitive, present stem, first singular, third plural, and singular imperative in parallel columns. Circle the evidence that assigns each conjugation.

Retrieval check. Name the principal part that distinguishes the two classes and state one present-form resemblance that does not decide the class.

1.2 Imperfect and future — transfer practice

Connection. The same English future can come from two Latin future systems, while imperfect forms share a broader *-ba-* marker.

Transfer task. Make a contrast table for first/second-conjugation future and third/third--*io*/fourth future. Add one imperfect form from each class and divide stem, tense sign, and ending.

Retrieval check. From memory, state which future uses *-bo/-bi-* and which begins first singular in *-am*.

1.3 Handwritten study and controlled composition — transfer practice

Connection. A synopsis across person and tense reveals whether a learner is producing forms or merely reciting one row.

Transfer task. Choose one lesson verb from each conjugation. Write first singular and third plural in present, imperfect, and future, then annotate stem, tense sign, and ending. Check only after all fifteen cells are complete.

Retrieval check. Explain why person and number must be identified before an English subject is supplied.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit 8: The Present Active System

Worksheet I.29 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.29

Focus: Conjugation, present forms, and clause parsing

Use: Use all four principal parts when a dictionary entry is supplied.

1. Classify by conjugation: *laudo, laudare; moneo, monere; rego, regere; capio, capere; audio, audire.*

-
2. Write all six present active indicative forms of *rego*.

-
3. Parse *laudamus, monet, capiunt, auditis*, giving lexical verb and translation.

-
4. Transform *Dominus animam custodit* to first-person plural subject, then to third-person plural subject.

-
5. Correct *Nos Deum laudat et glorificatis*.

-
6. **Text:** *Laudamus te. Benedicimus te. Adoramus te. Glorificamus te.*

Passage ID: I.29.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse every finite verb, identify the repeated object, and translate.

Worksheet I.32 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.32**Focus:** Mixed present-system recognition in liturgical clauses**Use:** Parse before using a memorized English text.

1. From *credo, credere, credidi, creditum*, identify present stem, conjugation, and the form *credimus*.
-

2. Give 2 singular, 1 plural, and 3 plural in present, imperfect, and future for *audio*.
-

3. Parse and translate *tollis, custodiebat, glorificabimus, regent*.
-

4. Transform *Credo in unum Deum* to first-person plural and imperfect singular.
-

5. Diagnose *Agnus Dei, qui tollit peccata mundi* when the Lamb is addressed as “you”.
-

6. **Text:** *Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis*.

Passage ID: I.32.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse the active finite verb fully; identify the command that belongs to a later verb class; translate.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Classify five conjugations from principal parts, produce present-system forms with at least 90 percent accuracy, and parse at least 18 of 20 active forms by lexical verb, person, number, tense, voice, and mood.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-I.9, The Perfect Active System.

If it is not met: Worksheets I.30 and I.31 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Conjugations and present endings — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The infinitives *capere* and *audire* assign third--*io* and fourth conjugation. Present *capio/audio* and third plurals *capiunt/audiunt* show resemblance, but principal parts control classification.

Imperfect and future — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. First and second conjugations use the *-bo, -bis, -bit* system; third, third--*io*, and fourth use *-am, -es, -et*. Imperfect forms must preserve the class-specific stem connection before *-ba-* and the personal ending.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Every cell must preserve the correct conjugation and tense system. The retrieval answer must state that the finite ending encodes person and number; English often requires an explicit pronoun that Latin need not print.

CHAPTER 2

Unit 8: The Present Active System

Solution I.29 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.29

Focus: Conjugation, present forms, and clause parsing

Use: Use all four principal parts when a dictionary entry is supplied.

- Classify by conjugation: *laudo, laudare; moneo, monere; rego, regere; capio, capere; audio, audire*.
Answer / model: First; second; third; third-*io*; fourth. A marked dictionary distinguishes second -*ere* from third -*ere*; the first principal part also helps.
- Write all six present active indicative forms of *rego*.
Answer / model: *rego, regis, regit, regimus, regitis, regunt*.
- Parse *laudamus, monet, capiunt, auditis*, giving lexical verb and translation.
Answer / model: *laudamus*: 1 plural present active indicative, “we praise”; *monet*: 3 singular, “he/she warns”; *capiunt*: 3 plural, “they take”; *auditis*: 2 plural, “you hear”.
- Transform *Dominus animam custodit* to first-person plural subject, then to third-person plural subject.
Answer / model: *Animam custodimus; Domini animam custodiunt* or, with a pronoun, *Ei animam custodiunt*. The verb endings must change.
- Correct *Nos Deum laudat et glorificatis*.
Answer / model: *Nos Deum laudamus et glorificamus*. Both verbs share first-person plural subject *nos*.
- Text:** *Laudamus te. Benedicimus te. Adoramus te. Glorificamus te.*
Passage ID: I.29.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse every finite verb, identify the repeated object, and translate.
Answer / notes: All four verbs are 1 plural present active indicative; *te* is repeated singular accusative object.
“We praise you. We bless you. We adore you. We glorify you.”

Solution I.32 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.32**Focus:** Mixed present-system recognition in liturgical clauses**Use:** Parse before using a memorized English text.

1. From *credo, credere, credidi, creditum*, identify present stem, conjugation, and the form *credimus*.
Answer / model: Present stem *cred-*; third conjugation; *credimus* is 1 plural present active indicative, “we believe”.
2. Give 2 singular, 1 plural, and 3 plural in present, imperfect, and future for *audio*.
Answer / model: Present: *audis, audimus, audiunt*. Imperfect: *audiebas, audiebamus, audiebant*. Future: *audies, audiemus, audient*.
3. Parse and translate *tollis, custodiebat, glorificabimus, regent*.
Answer / model: *tollis*: 2 singular present, “you take away”; *custodiebat*: 3 singular imperfect, “he/she was guarding”; *glorificabimus*: 1 plural future, “we shall glorify”; *regent*: 3 plural future, “they will rule”.
4. Transform *Credo in unum Deum* to first-person plural and imperfect singular.
Answer / model: *Credimus in unum Deum; Credebam in unum Deum*.
5. Diagnose *Agnus Dei, qui tollit peccata mundi* when the Lamb is addressed as “you”.
Answer / model: *Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi*. Relative verb must be 2 singular because the antecedent is addressed directly.
6. **Text:** *Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis*.
Passage ID: I.32.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse the active finite verb fully; identify the command that belongs to a later verb class; translate.
Answer / notes: *tollis*: 2 singular present active indicative of *tollo*; subject *qui*, antecedent *Agnus*; object *peccata*. *miserere*: 2 singular present deponent imperative with active meaning. “Lamb of God, who take away the sins of the world, have mercy on us.”

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.8, *The Present Active System*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet covers the active present system; perfect stems and passive morphology follow in later modules.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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